

1.2 Content

Listening

The listening examination lasts 30 minutes and is worth a quarter (25%) of the qualification. It consists of 40 marks.

This paper will consist of seven tasks, each based on a single recorded text.

Students will be given five minutes to read the questions before the paper begins and will be expected to respond to the questions as they listen.

Students will hear each text twice.

Recorded texts may be in the form of short statements, monologues and dialogues between two or three speakers. Where there is more than one speaker, the identity of each speaker will be clearly signposted.

Recordings and tasks will always be contextualised and, where appropriate, a purpose for the task will be identified.

The topics of the listening texts will be taken from a range of different situations, from both everyday life and academic contexts with which students will be familiar. One task type may be used with each listening text.

Correct spelling and grammatical accuracy will not be a requirement as long as the student's response is comprehensible.

The examination will begin with shorter statements, which build into short paragraphs and longer conversations. Task types demand a variety of input from students and include multiple-choice, multiple-matching, note-taking, table-completion and gap-fill questions.
